countries that were aligned with the Soviet Union. However, information on countries such as Saudi Arabia and the Gulf States (and Egypt from 1974), who were allied with the United States, was not included in the intelligence cooperation between the CIA and us.

During the golden years of the 1960s and ’70s, in which Israel was the source of much admiration among Third World countries, especially in Africa, the Israeli intelligence community and the IDF had a unique added value that served American interests in these parts of the world. These Third World countries saw the United States as a capitalist, imperialist, and colonialist power. They themselves were undergoing the process of liberation from colonialism and the adoption of socialist concepts. Israel, newly liberated from the colonialist power of Britain, having won its independence in a war of liberation against Arab states, who were not popular among black Africans (many of the slave traders in Africa were Arabs), a young country with a strong army, an agricultural wonder that had developed interesting forms of settlement, was much more attractive to the Third World countries than the United States. Our presence in these places served American interests.

Israel’s wars in 1967 and 1973 were a live combat laboratory for the United States, allowing it to examine its weapons systems over many years and take steps to ensure their supremacy over those of the Soviets and the Eastern Bloc. Operation Diamond in 1966—the defection of an Iraqi MiG 21 pilot along with his aircraft—was a strategic achievement that enabled American fighter pilots to fly a plane of this type for the first time, and American experts to study all of the aircraft’s systems.

Our presence in the Middle East has made us first-rate experts on the history, culture, language, traditions, and ways of thinking of Arabs in the Middle East. It would not be an exaggeration to say that our intelligence and security services have taken the discipline of HUMINT to a level nearing perfection. In my opinion, to this day HUMINT is the “aircraft carrier” on which all other intelligence disciplines rely. It is the only discipline in which you can ask sources questions, interrogate them, and get a complete picture of intelligence, rather than the partial or occasional pictures provided by the other intelligence disciplines. Because of this advantage, it is through HUMINT that you can get the best understanding of the intentions of the enemy’s decision makers. The CIA generally enjoyed the fruits of our HUMINT intelligence, whereas we usually enjoyed the fruits of American